a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

Cash & Company

TEACHER PD · MODULE 06

Capstone Defense Calibration

The norming protocol. The five Rubric Bank rubrics. Family and judge norms.

The 30-minute calibration meeting that prevents 10 hours of grading drama. The brief you read aloud at every Family Visit Day. The Sensitivity Pledge every teacher signs.

CONTENTS

Capstone Defense Calibration

The norming protocol. The five Rubric Bank rubrics. Family and judge norms.

01 What this module is for /
02 The 5 Rubric Bank rubrics (memorize the names) /
03 The norming protocol — a 30-minute meeting /
04 What to look for in a great Capstone Defense (across bands) /
05 Family and judge norms — what to brief outside evaluators on /
06 The Capstone Defense run-of-show (template) /
07 Certificate logistics — what gets sent home /
08 The Sensitivity Pledge (sign before earning the certificate) /
09 Module 06 knowledge check /
10 Activity tie-ins /
11 Module 06 — answers to the knowledge check /
12 You're done. (The 25-question certification quiz is next.) /

> Calibration is the practice that makes the Defense fair.

Module length: ~20 minutes **Activities to do alongside:** Activity 11 (Anchor-Paper Calibration), Activity 12 (Family Visit Day Run-of-Show) **Walkaway move:** a norming protocol you and a colleague can run in 30 minutes before any Capstone Defense.

What this module is for

The Capstone Defense is the program's culminating moment, every year, every grade. It is the day the student stands up in front of an audience — peers, family, teachers, community judges — and says here is what I made, here is what I learned, here is what I would change.

Calibration is the practice that makes the Defense fair. Without calibration, two teachers in the same school give the same student work two different scores, the kid sees the discrepancy, the parent calls, and the program loses credibility. With calibration — a 30-minute meeting before scoring, anchor papers, a shared rubric — two teachers score the same work within one rubric step nine times out of ten. That is the bar Cash to Company is built to clear.

This module teaches you:

1. The five Rubric Bank rubrics and which one to pull for which Capstone.
2. The norming protocol — exactly what to do in the 30 minutes before scoring.
3. Family and judge norms — what to brief outside-the-classroom evaluators on.
4. The certificate logistics — how the student earns the artifact and what gets sent home.

The 5 Rubric Bank rubrics (memorize the names)

The Rubric Bank lives in `_master/04_Rubric_Bank.md`. Five rubrics. Each is a single-point or analytic rubric calibrated to a band. You don't write your own rubric. You don't modify these. You pull the right one and use it.

Rubric	Used for
Business Plan Rubric	Plans, pitches, proposals — Grade 4 onward
Pitch Presentation Rubric	Defenses, presentations, market-day stalls — every grade with a defense
Budget Rubric	Budget artifacts — Grade 5 onward
Customer Research Rubric	Persona packs, interview summaries, A/B test results — Grade 7 onward (informally Grade 3+)
Reflection Writing Rubric	Capstone Journal portfolios, end-of-unit memos — every grade

For most Final Capstone Defenses, you will use the Pitch Presentation rubric for the live defense + the Reflection Writing rubric for the portfolio. The four Checkpoint scores feed into the final picture.

The rubrics are intentionally short. Each fits on one page. Each has 3–5 criteria, each scored 1–4. A student should be able to read the rubric and self-score before the teacher scores. That is a feature, not a bug.

The norming protocol — a 30-minute meeting

Run this with at least one colleague before any Capstone Defense scoring. Twice a year is the floor; before every Final Defense is the standard.

BEFORE THE MEETING (15 MINUTES OF PREP)

1. Pull 3–5 sample Capstone artifacts. Pick a deliberate range: one strong, one borderline, one weak.
2. Print the rubric you will use. One copy per teacher.
3. Print the anchor papers from the Rubric Bank — these are the program's pre-scored examples. Each rubric ships with anchor papers at score points 1, 2, 3, and 4.

THE MEETING ITSELF (30 MINUTES)

Minutes 0–5: Read the anchor papers. Each teacher reads silently. No discussion yet.

Minutes 5–10: First sample, individual scoring. Each teacher scores Sample 1 against the rubric. Don't talk yet. Don't show your scores yet.

Minutes 10–15: Reveal and discuss. Each teacher names their score and the criterion that drove it. Use this language: "I scored Criterion 3 a 2 because the persona names a demographic but not a behavior." If scores differ by more than one rubric step on any criterion, that is the signal to discuss until you converge.

Minutes 15–20: Second sample, individual scoring + reveal. Repeat. By this sample, you should be tighter.

Minutes 20–25: Third sample. Repeat once more. If you are still divergent by more than one step, do a fourth.

Minutes 25–30: Decisions. Agree on the rubric anchor for any criterion where you converged late. Write the agreement on the back of the rubric and tape it to the wall of your room. "In our school, a Criterion 3 score of 3 requires a named behavior, not a demographic." That note is now the local convention. Future scoring uses it.

AFTER THE MEETING

You both score the rest of the Defenses independently. If you encounter a paper that doesn't fit the local convention, flag it. You re-converge at the end of the year if needed.

This is a 30-minute investment that prevents 10 hours of grading drama, parent calls, and "but Mr. Lee gave it a 3" arguments.

What to look for in a great Capstone Defense (across bands)

The Pitch Presentation rubric has five criteria. Each is band-locked. Here is what each looks like at its strongest, by band.

CRITERION 1 — IS THE CUSTOMER SPECIFIC?

- **K-2 strong:** "My helper is the bus driver, Mr. Patel. He drives bus 17."
- **3-5 strong:** "My customer is Lila in 5th grade. She brings her own pencils because her brother always loses his."
- **6-8 strong:** "My customer is the parent of an 11-year-old who has soccer practice three days a week and needs after-practice snacks they don't have to make."
- **9-12 strong:** "My target customer segment is dual-income parents in zip codes 37205 and 37215, with kids ages 9–13 in organized sports, with household income above the median, and a stated frustration about post-practice nutrition."

CRITERION 2 — WHERE IS THE EVIDENCE?

- **K-2:** Evidence is "I saw it." A drawing of the helper, with a sentence about what the helper did.
- **3-5:** Evidence is "I asked someone, and they said..." A 1-paragraph quote from a real interview.
- **6-8:** Evidence is "I have transcripts and patterns." Three interview summaries with one consistent frustration named.
- **9-12:** Evidence is "I have qualitative + quantitative data." Survey results, interview transcripts, and a behavioral observation, with a synthesis.

CRITERION 3 — IS THE MATH HONEST?

- **K-2:** "How much does the sticker cost? How many do we sell? Add them up."
- **3-5:** A simple price-cost calculation, one product.
- **6-8:** A contribution margin calculation. Variable cost, fixed cost, a pricing recommendation.
- **9-12:** Unit economics, a 3-month cash projection, a CAC/LTV-lite estimate, and the assumptions stated.

CRITERION 4 — IS THE MESSAGING HONEST?

- **K-2:** "What does the sign say?" The sign tells the truth about the item.
- **3-5:** "What does the ad say?" The ad doesn't claim what the product can't do.

- **6-8:** Two ad variants tested, with the more honest one chosen and defended.
- **9-12:** A messaging system that respects the customer (no urgency tricks, no fake scarcity, no manipulation).

CRITERION 5 — WHAT WOULD YOU CHANGE?

- **K-2:** "What's one thing you'd do different next time?"
- **3-5:** "What's one thing you'd change, and why?"
- **6-8:** "What evidence would tell you to change?"
- **9-12:** "What's the next experiment? What hypothesis does it test? What outcome would change your mind?"

A great Defense across all five criteria, in any band, is honest, specific, evidence-pointing, and curious about the next step. A weak Defense is vague, certain, unevidenced, and doesn't know what to revise.

Family and judge norms — what to brief outside evaluators on

Family Visit Day. Community judging panels. Outside experts. Older students. All are common Defense audiences. All need a 5-minute brief before they walk in. Here is the script:

> Welcome. Thank you for coming. Today the students will defend their Capstone — a project they've worked on all year. Three quick norms we'd like you to honor:
>
> First, please don't compare students to each other. Compare each student's work to where they started in September. Growth is the metric.
>
> Second, please ask questions, not statements. "Which people, and how do you know?" is the question we ask all year. You'll see students answer it. Your questions can echo it.
>
> Third, please don't ask about the family. Cash to Company never asks students about their family's money or family situation. We use sample-family hypotheticals. Please do the same. If you're curious about a number, ask "what's your sample case?" not "what does this look like at your house?"
>
> We'll hand you a small note card with these three norms and the rubric. The student will speak for 4 minutes (or 7 minutes for high school). You'll have 2 minutes to ask questions. Then we move to the next student. Thank you for being here.

Print the brief. Hand it to every outside evaluator. Read it aloud at the start of the Defense day. The norms protect the student and protect the program from drift.

COMMON OUTSIDE-EVALUATOR FAILURE MODES (TO GENTLY REDIRECT)

- **The hype-bro evaluator:** "Great job! You're going to crush it!" — Redirect: "Let's stay specific. What about the work was the strongest evidence move?"
- **The probing evaluator:** "Does your family have a credit card?" — Redirect: "We're keeping family questions out. The sample case is what we work with."
- **The "when I was your age" evaluator:** "Let me tell you about my first business." — Redirect: "We're going to keep the focus on their work — but I'd love to chat after."
- **The harsh evaluator:** "That number is wrong." — Redirect: "Let's frame it as a question — 'how did you arrive at this number?' — and let the student walk us through."

You are the Defense host. You set the temperature.

The Capstone Defense run-of-show (template)

For Family Visit Day or any panel Defense, this is the standard run-of-show:

```
 00:00  Welcome + 3 norms (you read them)
00:05  Cash video clip (1 minute, the year's anchor video)
00:08  Student 1 Defense (4 min K-8 / 7 min HS)
        + 2 min Q&A
00:14  Student 2 Defense + Q&A
00:20  Student 3 Defense + Q&A
[continues — pace is 6 min K-8, 9 min HS per student]
[break at 30 min if more than 5 students]
        ...
End:   Class reflection — "what's one thing you noticed
       about another student's defense?"
       Certificate distribution.
       Thank evaluators. Send them home with the take-home card.
```

Run-of-show printed. Tape on the wall. Time-keeper assigned (a parent volunteer or a paraprofessional). The Defense day works because the run-of-show is followed.

Certificate logistics — what gets sent home

Two artifacts go home per student per year:

1. The Capstone Certificate. Branded, name-filled. Names the student, the grade, the Capstone title, and the year. Signed by the teacher. (Template artwork ships with this PD as `Cash_Certified_Teacher_Certificate.html` for teachers; an analogous student certificate is in the program's main asset library.)

2. The Capstone Portfolio summary. A 1-page summary of the four Checkpoint scores + the Final Defense score, with one teacher comment per criterion. This is the artifact that goes in the cumulative student file and that a receiving teacher reads next year.

For the teacher's own Cash Certified Teacher PD certificate: the certificate ships as `Cash_Certified_Teacher_Certificate.html`. Customize the name field. Print at 8.5×11 landscape. Sign and date. The certificate is renewable annually; the renewal protocol is the 20-minute summer change-log read.

The Sensitivity Pledge (sign before earning the certificate)

Every Cash Certified Teacher signs this paragraph. It lives at the bottom of the certificate. By signing, you commit to honoring it for the duration of the certification.

> I commit to the Cash to Company sensitivity rules. I will not ask my students about their family's finances. I will not promise them wealth, success, or specific outcomes. I will not bring partisan politics, religion, or current events into Cash to Company instruction. I will use neutral hypotheticals when financial scenarios are needed. I will use the misconception-correction script (surface, sharpen, settle) to address student claims with evidence rather than disapproval. I will run the calibration protocol with at least one colleague before scoring any Final Capstone Defense. I will report any concerning student disclosure (e.g., signs of family hardship) through the proper school channel — not the curriculum.

Module 06 knowledge check

1. Name the five Rubric Bank rubrics.
2. State the three norms you brief outside evaluators on at the start of a Defense day.
3. State the minimum frequency for running the calibration protocol.
4. What language do you use to redirect a probing evaluator who asks a student about their family?

Activity tie-ins

- **Activity 11 (Anchor-Paper Calibration):** Run a 30-minute calibration session with a partner using the three sample anchor papers in the Activity Packet. Score, reveal, discuss, converge.
- **Activity 12 (Family Visit Day Run-of-Show):** Build a run-of-show for a hypothetical 8-student Family Visit Day in your grade band. Include the brief, the schedule, and the take-home card.

Module 06 — answers to the knowledge check

1. Business Plan, Pitch Presentation, Budget, Customer Research, Reflection Writing.

2. (a) No comparing students to each other; growth is the metric. (b) Ask questions, not statements; echo the spine question. (c) No family questions; use the sample case.
3. Twice a year is the floor; before every Final Defense is the standard.
4. "We're keeping family questions out. The sample case is what we work with."

You're done. (The 25-question certification quiz is next.)

When you have completed all six modules and at least 8 of the 12 activities, take the `Certification_Quiz.md`. Score 80% or above. Sign the Sensitivity Pledge. Print your certificate. You're Cash Certified.

Welcome to the program. The kids you teach will be a little less wrong, every week. That is the whole point.

One promise.

Calibration is the practice that makes the Defense fair.

Cash to Company is built so a curriculum coordinator, a foundation officer, a parent, or a teacher can pick up any one of these strategic references and meet the program at full strength on the first page.

No promise of wealth. No probing of family finances. No partisan content. One question, asked patiently for thirteen years: which people, and how do you know?

For educational and operational use. This document is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment is cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).